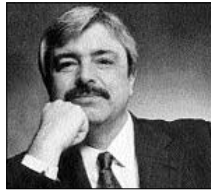




100...And There Was Order!



106 Modem Man



120 Hackers Did It!

Digital Leisure

Technology Beyond Work

Touched By Tech

Creating A Million Smiles

Mobility, technology and digital photography combine to offer livelihood, and a smile

Renuka Rane

Babulal Mishra, of Jamuna Park, Delhi drives a unique auto rickshaw to his workplace—the courts, at Delhi. He is a digital photographer tending to the passport photo requirements of applicants, or litigants near the courts. His auto is a converted, mobile digital studio, and attracts a lot of attention from onlookers. Mishra simply clicks a picture with his digital camera, and takes a printout from a photo-printer, all within a matter of minutes!

He gets anywhere between 20 to 60 customers

each day, and has been doing this for a year and a half now, ever since he became part of HP Digital Photo Studio's—Project Muskaan.

The Genesis

HP Digital Studio, a chain of instant, digital, photo print service has integrated digital printing. 'Project Muskaan', or the 'HP Digital Photo Studio' project, was launched by HP India in May 2002 as a platform to generate sustainable self-employment, and enable revenue generation for people from urban and rural India.

Explaining the objectives behind the venture, HP India's digital photography products, consumer segment manager, Ashwini Aggarwal says, "Project Muskaan was launched in May 2002 to drive the concept of

digital photography into the Indian mainstream photography segment. We wanted to explore how technology could be used in emerging markets and be fitted into new products, which would specifically address the needs of emerging markets in India."

Existing photo studios and new entrepreneurs have setup shop through Project Muskaan by using the HP Digital Studio package provided. The project has an ever increasing 5,000-member franchise network servicing over two million customers a month, and is spread across 75 cities and 1,000 villages in India.

Products And Prices

An individual photographer, or an existing photo studio can avail of the HP Digital Studio package, which includes a multi-media personal computer,



Imaging: Bineesh Sreedharan